Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role at Halden Pay. I bring nine years of experience designing, building and operating production batch and streaming data platforms and cloud data warehouses at scale, with a focus on reliable pipelines, clear data contracts and trusted data models.

In my current role at Lukovac Freight Hub, I own the ingestion layer of a platform with approximately 140 Airflow DAGs and migrated more than 420 transformation models to dbt. The work included adding tests to every model and reducing nightly runtime from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I also introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine per month to two, and built a Kafka-based pipeline processing around 30 million shipment-tracking events daily. These experiences align closely with Halden Pay's need for someone to own a shared platform, establish data quality standards and simplify systems so teams can work effectively.

My background also includes comparable cloud experience through AWS EMR and S3 processing, plus Snowflake and Redshift cloud data warehouses. At Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to process around 1.2 TB of raw files daily and designed a Redshift cloud data warehouse using dimensional modelling and a star schema with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams. Alongside Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt and Docker, I have developed reusable data tooling adopted by four teams and mentor colleagues in my current role. I would bring this practical platform experience to Halden Pay's Google Cloud environment, while learning the specifics of its stack.

Halden Pay's focus on business payments and its values of Together, Ownership and Pace particularly appeal to me. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to a platform that supports analysts, data scientists and product teams, and to discuss how my experience could support the Data Platform team.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm